



Dreame DreameBot D9 Max Robot Vacuum

Keeping your home clean can feel like a never-ending task, especially if you reside in Indian metropolitan cities prone to dust throughout the year. It is understandable, therefore, that Robotic Vacuum Cleaners sound like such a promising concept and have surged in popularity in recent years. But how effective are they in practice, particularly the affordable and mid-range options? To provide a better perspective, we checked out the Dreame DreameBot D9 Max.

Design and Maintenance

In terms of shape and size, the DreameBot D9 Max looks similar to most other robot vacuum cleaners that we have experienced. It is made of high-grade plastic that looks and feels premium and can resist scuff marks from the robot bumping into expected and unexpected obstacles rather well. The glossy top surface looks appealing but inevitably catches smudges during operation and maintenance.

The protrusion of the LiDAR navigation sensor adds some extra height and

prevents it from gliding under my bed, as some other robotic vacuum cleaners can. Still, this robot can easily clean underneath my sofa and coffee table. The 570ml dustbin capacity is above average compared to other options that support wet mopping. For my home, the capacity proved sufficient for 5 to 8 days of cleaning. You can control the cleaner using voice commands (Alexa, Google Assistant, or Siri), the mobile phone app, or the two physical buttons. The voice assistants only support basic functionality, and activating them isn't as straightforward.

PROS:

- Powerful suction and effective dry cleaning
- Great navigation and mapping
- Can effectively deal with most obstacles
- Great battery life
- Large dustbin

CONS:

- Mopping is not as effective

Navigation and mapping

The DreameBot D9 Max proved surprisingly adept at mapping my home. It does so automatically when you first run it and can also update and add more rooms or extend existing ones as and when it encounters new spaces later.

On the Dreame Home app, you can split or merge rooms on the map or mark 'No-go Zones' for regions like the bathroom area that you wish to avoid. Once it is done with mapping, the cleaner can effectively navigate to where you want it to and can seamlessly return to its charging dock after cleaning or in case it needs to recharge its battery. The only time it got confused was when we had powered off the charging dock.

Cleaning and Battery Life

The DreameBot D9 Max supports a maximum 4000pa suction capacity in the Turbo mode. By default the suction power is set to 'Strong' and the cleaner can automatically increase suction to Turbo when it cleans carpets or footmats (once the option is enabled in the app). If the floor is cluttered, the D9 Max will leave patches of unclean areas as it navigates around obstacles. In our testing, the D9 proved quite effective at picking dust and grime from corners and edges. We measured 75dB of noise while cleaning in the strong suction mode which is optimal. Edges of a room are cleaned first and then it proceeds with cleaning the inner region. The battery capacity is rated to last for 250 sq meters of cleaning. Honestly, the battery life was never a bother because the cleaner charges itself and, if interrupted mid-cycle, resumes cleaning from where it left off. Your mileage will vary.

Should you buy it?

The Dreame DreameBot D9 Max can efficiently deal with everyday household grime and has the basics well covered, especially considering its value price. It is quite effective at brooming the floor and cleaning carpets and can reliably maintain a neat living space.

—Deepak Singh